TERMS OF REFERENCE

Call for External Experts: CTA/CEI/EE/2017

Specific Assignment: Provide Support for the Technical Implementation of CTA's Data for Agriculture (Data4Ag) Project

1. About CTA

The Technical Centre for Agricultural and Rural Cooperation (CTA) is a joint international institution of the African, Caribbean and Pacific (ACP) Group of States and the European Union (EU). Its mission is to advance food and nutritional security, increase prosperity and encourage sound natural resource management in ACP countries. It provides access to information and knowledge, facilitates policy dialogue and strengthens the capacity of agricultural and rural development institutions and communities. CTA operates under the framework of the Cotonou Agreement and is funded by the EU.

1.1 The Data4Ag Project

The Data4Ag project is aimed at positioning farmers' organisations to take best advantage of data-driven services as part of the digitalisation revolution in agriculture. CTA has interventions at four levels: 1) Looking at validating field projects on the foundation of data services through supporting geo-located farmer registration as a foundation for digital services; 2) Expert diagnosis of data services benefitting smallholders which can be coordinated through farmer-led enterprises and organisations; 3) Capacity development in data management; and 4) Policy change to facilitate farmers access to data services and support to farmers organisation in implementation. The current assignment focuses on field projects and is described in more detail here below.

1.2 Field Projects

With the availability of mobile phones across Africa and messaging services to farmers developing, a number of new possibilities have emerged for farmers' organisations to provide services to their members. To identify how data services can be used by these organisations to register profile and provide services to their members, a study is proposed that identifies existing activities and potential opportunities for the Pan African Farmers Organisation (PAFO) and its members.

CTA has been supporting the management of data systems with a number of organisations working with smallholder farmers. These range from the use of data systems to manage access to markets for organic farmers in Samoa to farmer profiling and registration systems in Southern and East Africa. This collection of data for profiling also extended to agribusinesses in the Caribbean and the Pacific through regional associations. At the same time, CTA has supported the African farmers' organisations to identify priorities in data management through its support of their involvement in Global Open Data for Agriculture and Nutrition (GODAN) and CTA's work on the DFID-funded project GODAN action. This had led to an interest from both the World Farmers' Organisation and PAFO in better data management in farmer-owned cooperatives, associations and farmers' organisations. Through the support of the African regional farmers' organisations in 2014, a discussion forum was established comprising of over 250 farmers' organisations which developed a number of successful cases of organisations from each region that were successfully serving their members. Working together with the regional farmers' organisations, a number of interventions were prioritised. The first of these was working with Southern African Confederation of Agricultural Unions (SACAU) where over 30,000 farmers have been registered in Swaziland and Lesotho. Projects in Burkina Faso, Burundi, Uganda and Kenya have followed.

2. Objectives and Deliverables of the Consultancy

The objective of the support is twofold:

1. To ensure the activities within this project take best advantage of lessons learnt from the concluded projects in Uganda, Lesotho and Swaziland and to mentor the activities in Kenya with Eastern Africa Farmers federation (EAFF) , in Burundi with Confédération des Associations des Producteurs Agricoles pour le Développement (CAPAD) and in Burkina Faso with Fédération des Professionnels Agricoles du Burkina (FEPAB). This will involve overseeing the implementation of the projects on behalf of CTA and ensuring adherence to the initial deadlines and providing professional advice on project implementation. (Further details of the Data4Ag project are available on the CTA website – (https://www.cta.int/en/projects/data4ag).
2. To help facilitate learning in the PAFO network. This will include at least the following:
    a. Support for the working papers and policy briefs produced covering Data4Ag;
    b. Mentoring of farmers' organisations to develop their plans to implement data-driven solutions.
    c. An overview presentation of the project as part of a webinar on the project findings.

Work package	Activity	Estimated n° of days	Deliverable	Months
1 Field project support	1.1 Finalisation of project work and report with recommendations for FOs	25 days	1.1.1 Project report; Two (2) field visits as necessary to Southern Africa and Kenya.	October 2019 – January 2020
2 Discussion paper	2.1 Inputs to intro Data4Ag discussion paper	5 days	2.1.1 Inputs for introduction	October 2019
	2.2 Inputs to methodology section	10 days	2.2.1 Chapter "7" process chapter	November 2019
	2.3 Preparation for Presentation during Strike 2 Summit *	5 days	2.3.1 Process presentation	December 2020
TOTAL		**45 days**		

* The Strike 2 summit is a series of events coordinated by blockchain and innovation group The Fork in Amsterdam. Co-organised with the Dutch Ministry of Agriculture, CTA, CGIAR, IBM, Ahold Delhaize, Unilever and Deloitte. The series focuses on the application of Blockchain, Artificial Intelligence and emerging technologies to enhance food systems.
The first focusses on consumer trust, the second on farmers finance, and he third on the value chain.

3. Required Profile of the Consultant

- Experience of working in data management and preferably with farmer registration.
- Post graduate level education with more than 10 years' experience in data /ICT projects in development. Ideally the candidate should have experience in ACP countries.
- Strong communication, analytical and writing skills in English.

4. Duration of the Assignment

The term of the services shall be for a period of 5 months (October 2019 – January 2020). A maximum total of 45 working days is foreseen during this period.

5. Maximum budget

The maximum budgetary provision for professional fees for this assignment is Euro 20,250. N.B. Reimbursables, if any, will be in accordance with CTA regulations and will be managed separately by CTA.

6. Submission of the offers

The consultant is expected to submit the following by e-mail to addison@cta.int: cc: stals@cta.int and experts@cta.int :

- Confirmation of availability to undertake the assignment during the period indicated.;
- An updated curriculum vitae;
- A brief methodology/approach to the assignment (max. 2 pages) including references to similar projects / assignments undertaken in the past three (3) years;
- Proposed budget for the assignment (e.g. daily fee rate x number of days needed). N.B. Reimbursables, if any, will be in accordance with CTA regulations and will be managed separately by CTA.

7. Deadline for submission of offers

The deadline for submission of offers is fixed at **22 September 2019 @ 23h59 (CET).**

8. Technical & financial evaluation of the offers

The verification of the technical and professional capacities and the financial evaluation (which the consultant must submit for consideration, otherwise his/her application will be deemed non-compliant) of each offer is carried out in accordance with the following weighting and awarding criteria:

Technical evaluation

- Updated CV of the expert, in particular training and experience in relation with the services to be provided and the tasks that will be assigned to them (40%).
- Methodology and approach (60%) including:
  - Understanding of the assignment (25%
  - Clarity of the approach (25%)
  - Relevant references (10%).

No other awarding criterion will be used and no change will be made to the weightings. Offers whose technical mark does not reach on average 80 of the maximum technical mark (100 points) are rejected. When the technical evaluation is completed, the financial offer of those offers not eliminated in the technical evaluation will be examined.

Financial evaluation

- Your budget (including your daily fee rate) for the assignment.

9. Contract award

The contract is awarded to the tenderer:

- Who is available for the assignment;
- Who provides the technical and professional guarantees required;
- Whose tender is compliant with the administrative requirements;
- Whose financial tender does not exceed the budget allocated to the project; and
- Whose tender, said to be the most economically advantageous, gets the highest score, said score being obtained by a weighing between the technical quality and the price, according to an 80/20 distribution key.